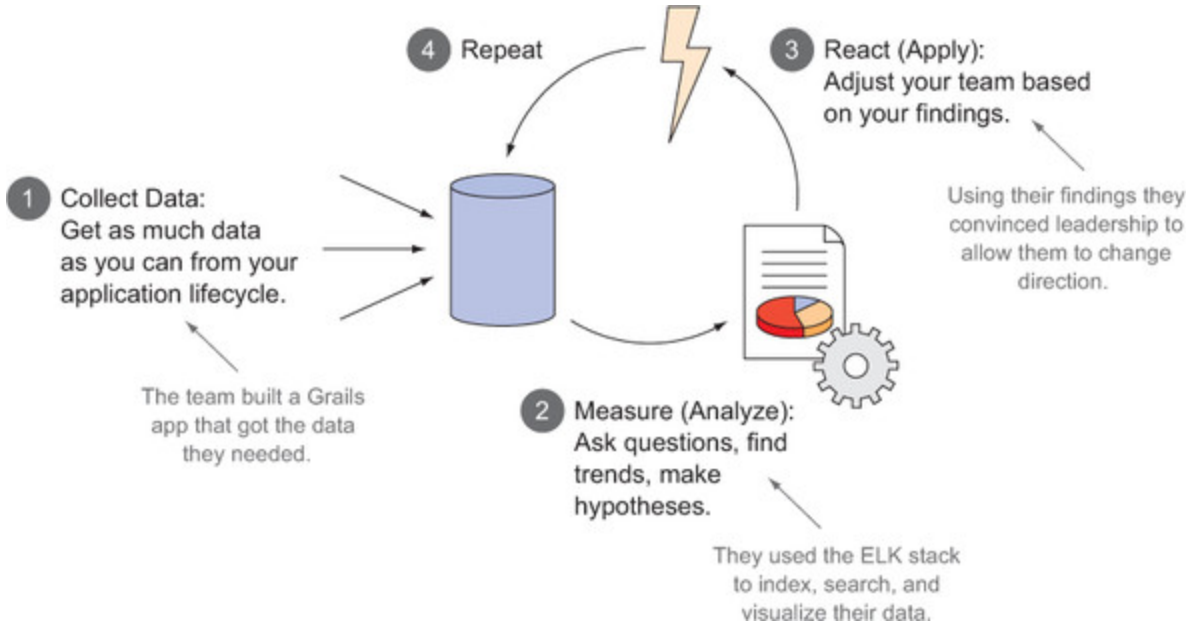


Now that the development team had made the loop once, the next question was how frequently they should go all the way around it. The data collection was automated so they had continuous data that they could react to at any time. But they settled on letting their sprints run their course and did their analysis and application before each new sprint started.

Before they were collecting and analyzing all of this data, they were only tracking velocity every sprint to make sure their completion rate stayed consistent. The better they got at mining their data, the more insight they obtained into how they were operating as a team and the better they became at making informed decisions on the best ways to operate. When problems came up, they looked at the data to figure out where the problem really was instead of making snap decisions on where they *thought* the problem was. Finally, when they wanted to make recommendations to leadership, they knew how to communicate their thoughts up the chain in a meaningful way that could effect change.

A positive side effect to this was that they felt free to experiment when it came to their development process. Because they now had a system that allowed them to measure changes as they made them, they started a new practice in which the team would adopt any changes a member suggested, as long as they had could measure their hypotheses.